



Everything jingle bell by RidchardTerry

Example of Game Design Document TALES OF HARMONY

Game design, Narrative & Art pre-production

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Subject to change

This document is an ongoing work in progress and represents an early proof of concept.
This sample is not indicative of the final product content and quality and
is completely subject to change

Spoiler warning

This document contains an overview of system detail cut from the Main GDD. Didn't show
the whole concept. It shows how I write documents and the process of thought and writing skill.
Still, this document contain narrative content potential to spoils video game concept

The above Information is accurate as of the 27 March 2026

DESIGN OVERVIEW

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ABOUT THE GAME

TALES OF HARMONY is the rhytm action rogue-like 2D sidescroller game. Also the 1st game designed by author.



Single Player Experience

Developed for PC and Console. gameplay driven by repetitive gameplay-loop action adventure combine with rhythm base game



2D Sidescroller / Platformer

The game pillar focused on fast and smmoth combat, astonishing boss fight and rhythm pacing enemy movement.



Narrative-Lead Gameplay



Exploration and Secret

II

GAMEPLAY LOOP

Beat the final boss, Try build combo form boons and Finish story of the game.

Run end when Player /
Final boss 's HP bar reach 0

Sitting legth per session: 1-3 hours
Aimed for 8-12 hours till final boss

Total game length 20 hours

*Gated by difficulty and narrative sequence
and side mission*

III

WORLD SETTING

**Setting - Fairy tales fantasy /
Aesop's Fables**

when the gods bring Instruments
to the books by accident and fuse
many books together Create the
Harsh and Rough ways to bring
music to the Fables's world. Almost
called it Instrumental Apocalypse.

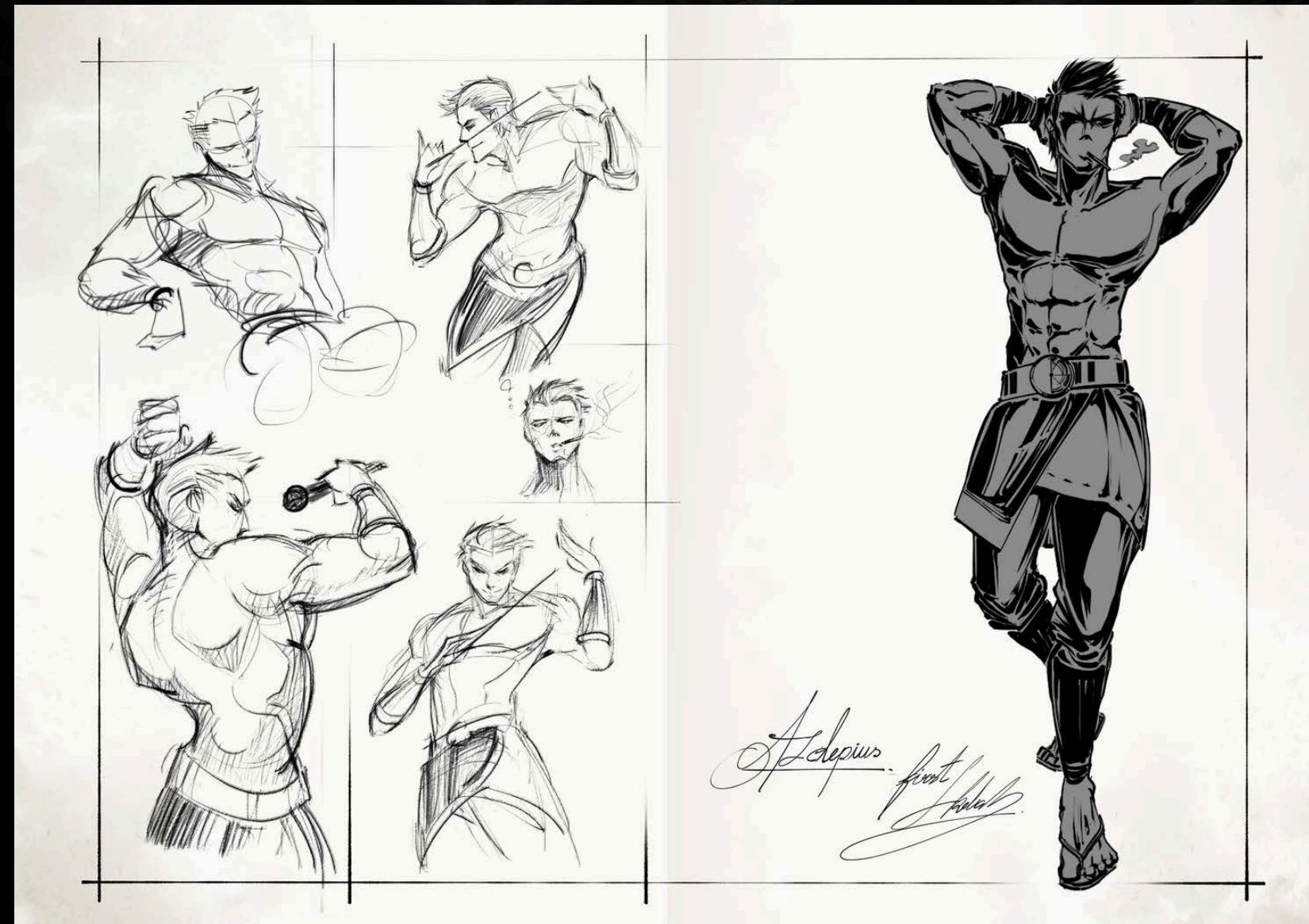
4 MAIN CHAPTERS - 5 MAIN BOSSES

Explore → Fight → Loot → Upgrade → Explore
Repeat Till Final Boss

IV

MAIN CHARACTER

ASCLEPIUS - GOD OF HEALING





ASCLEPIUS'S ABILITY

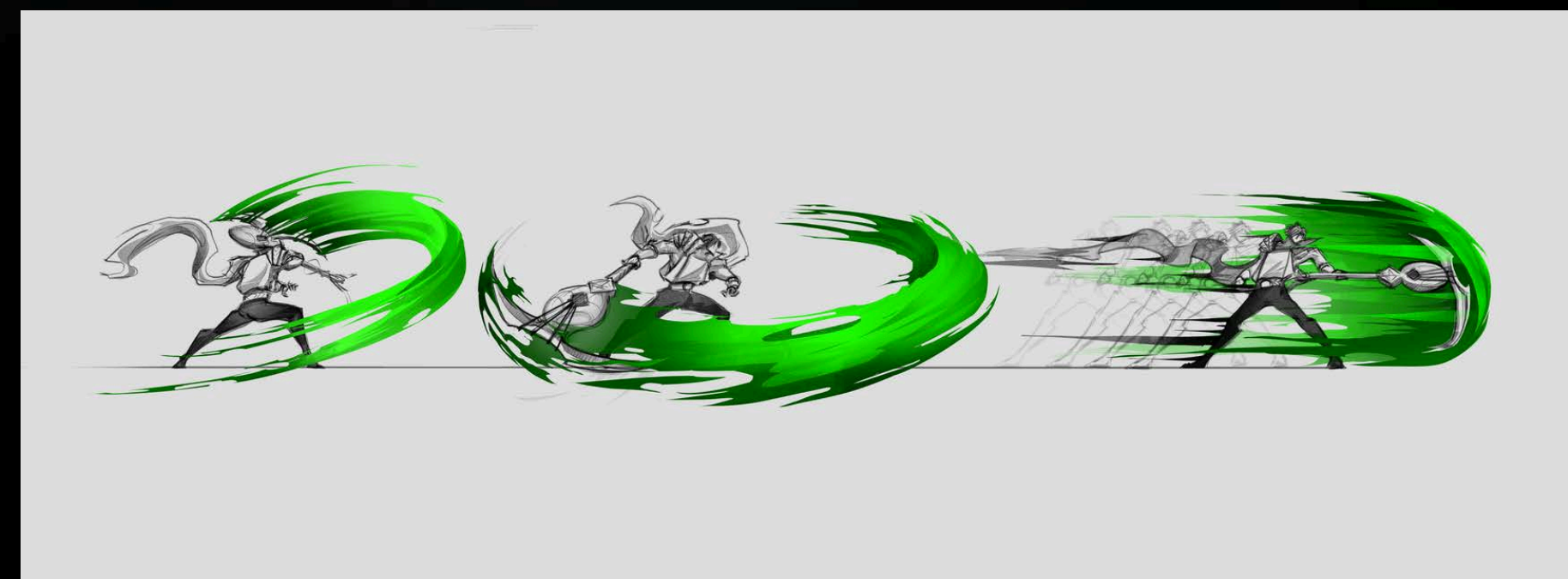
ASCLEPIUS'S COMBAT SYSTEM

Asclepius has his favourite weapon that bounded to his soul: **Ophis Iasis**. **Ophis Iasis** can be transformed into 3 appearances. Can switch freely between each other.

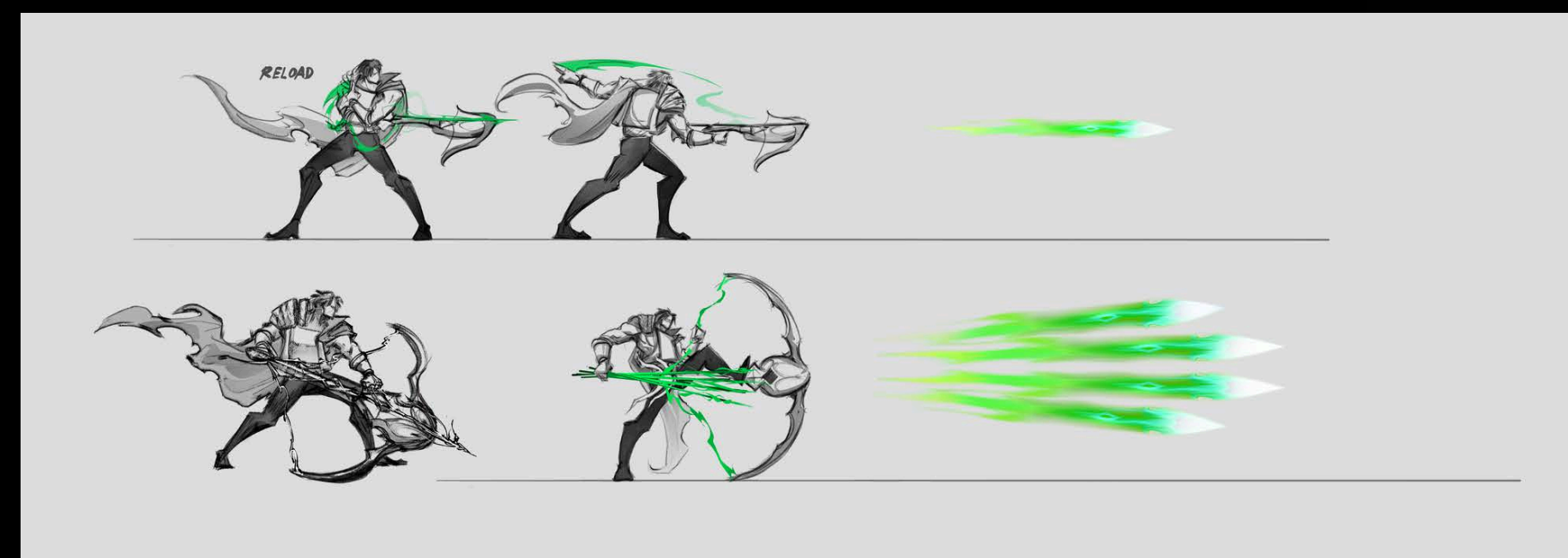
Axe Form; Attack with 3 hit sequences melee, can be loop. Light and fast, smooth, can stun lock weak enemies. Can be charged for a stronger attack

Scythe Form; A slow steady but heavy attack form but if used after specific action of another form, it will be faster and deadlier and can also be used to purge some unique enemy.

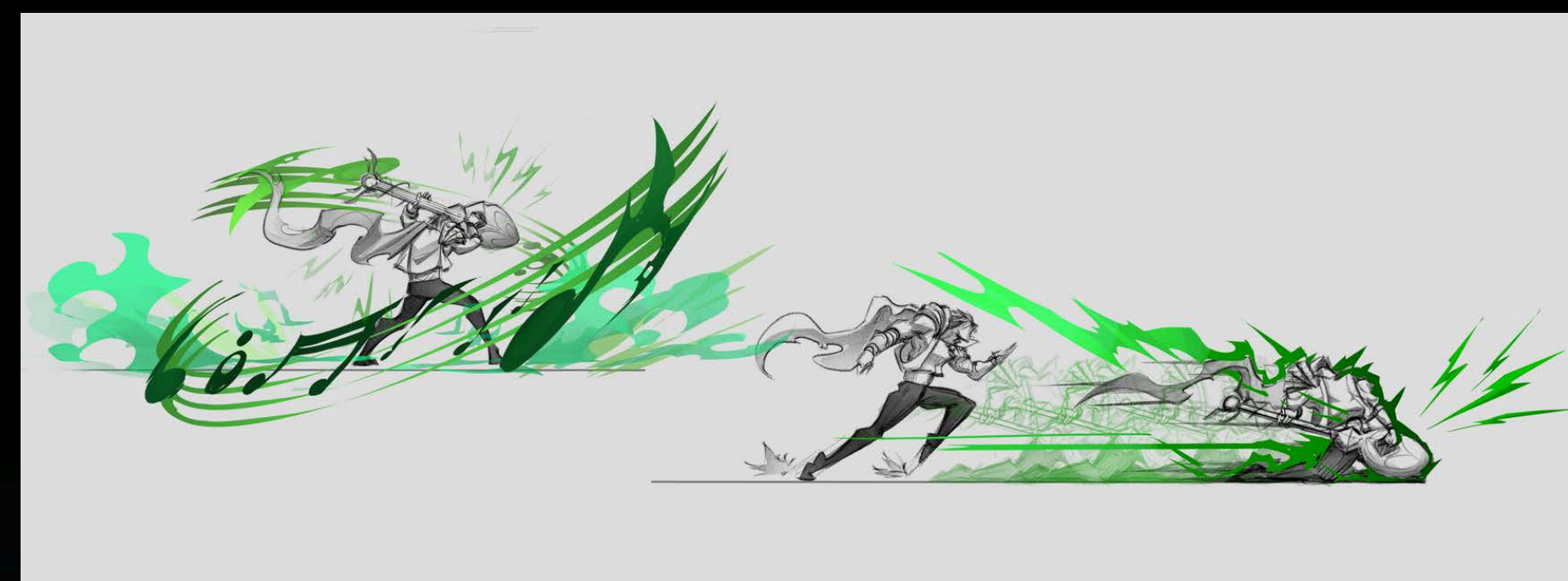
Barista Form; Long range attack mode. Can be charged for a stronger shot, effective on aerial enemies.



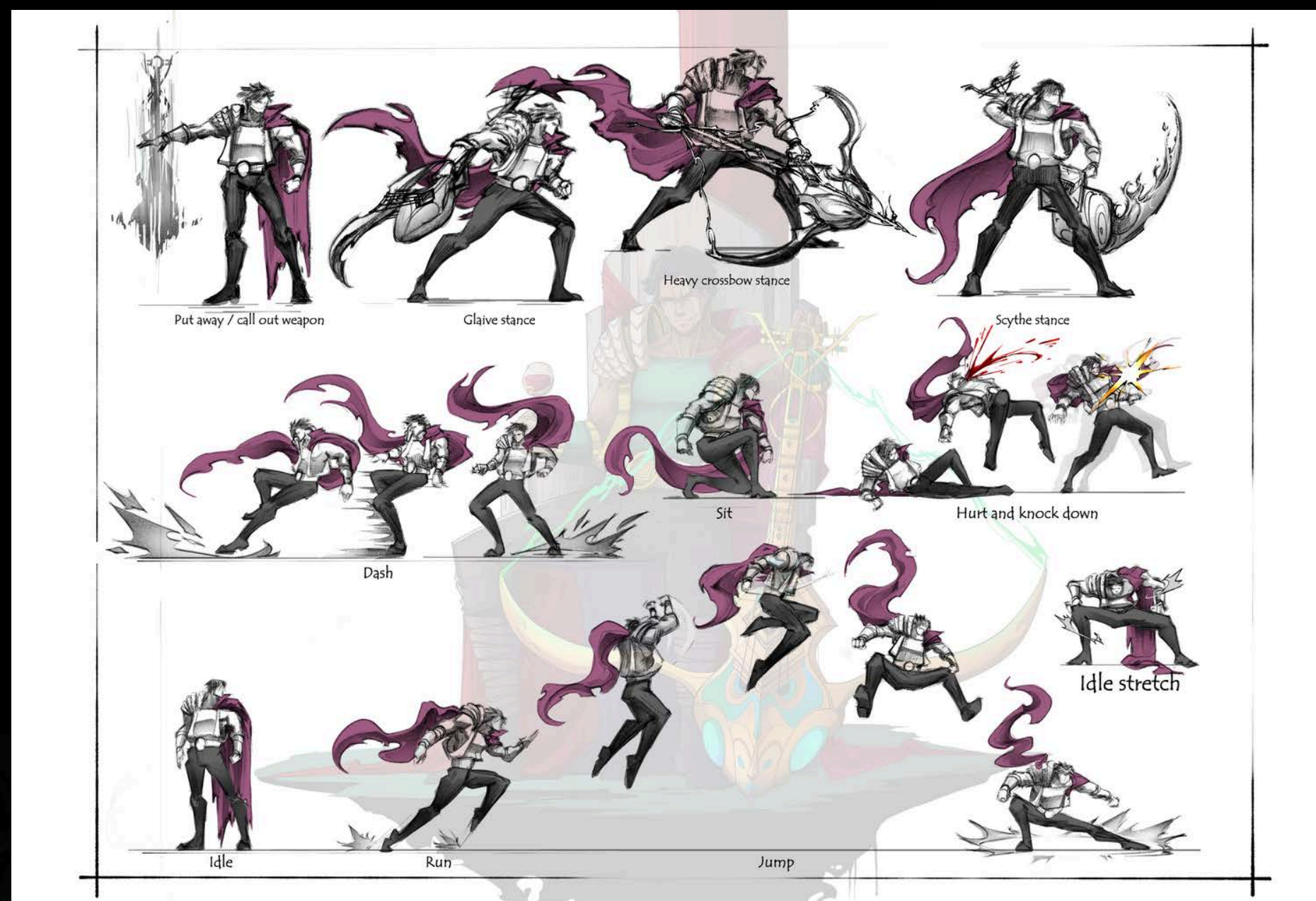
ASCLEPIUS's Melee Attack Design



ASCLEPIUS's Ranged Attack Design



ASCLEPIUS's Performance Attack Design

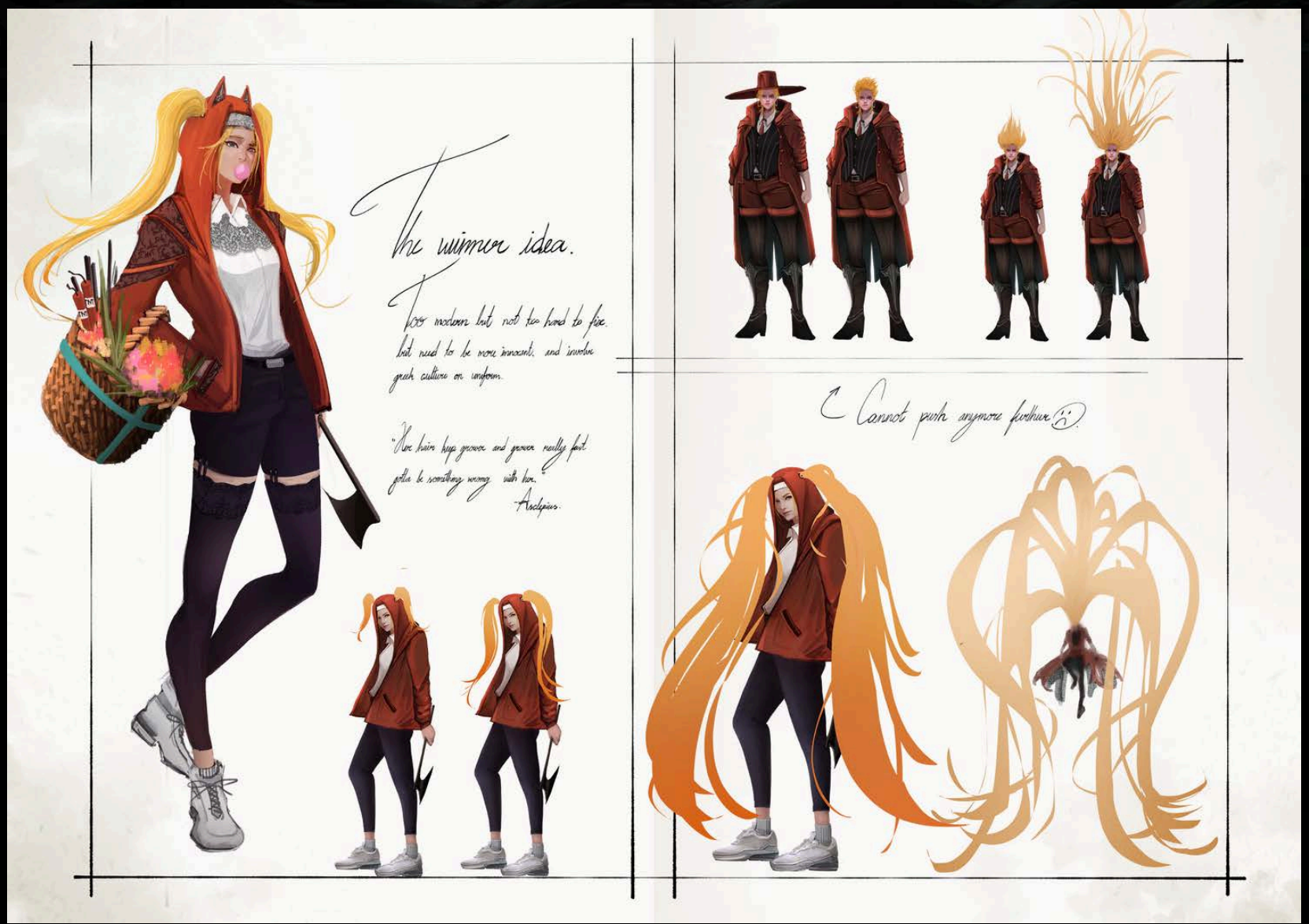


ASCLEPIUS's Basic movement



VI MAIN CHARACTER'S COMPANION

ALICIA - LEADER OF THE CHILD SOLDIER



VII ALICIA'S ABILITIES

THE COMPANION SYSTEM

ALICIA is the player's **Companion system**, a system for non-playable allies who supports the player without adding mechanical burden or requiring micromanagement.

Introducing an AI-controlled ally that accompanies the player throughout gameplay. The companion enhances combat, exploration, and narrative delivery through the personality of the companion.

DESIGN GOAL

- Support the player without requiring direct control
- Reinforce immersion and emotional connection
- Complement player when do core mechanic gameplay (flawless combat + rhythm sync)
- Balancing and push and pull stretch of situation, make player stay in fun zone all the play time.
- Give a clue and dialogue about environment and immersive feeling of journey

CORE FEATURE OF COMPANION

PASSIVE BEHAVIOR

To make the gameplay is companion identity not too awkward

- Automatically follows player with smooth pathfinding
- Avoids enemy collision and line-of-fire
- Cannot be damaged or targeted (must be tested before decide but must not be a burden for player)

CONTEXTUAL ASSISTANT SYSTEM

The companion provides situational support based on situation and gameplay. Separate into **exploration** and **combat**

Combat Assistance System

- Throws resources (e.g., health, ammo, buffs)
- Detects low player health or critical state (Prioritizes survival)
- Highlights enemies or weak points
- Triggers assist abilities (e.g., stun, distraction)
- Revive player with consumable item
- Notificate player when some resource or cooldown is ready
- Notice the perfect rhythm sync of some of player's critical attack
-

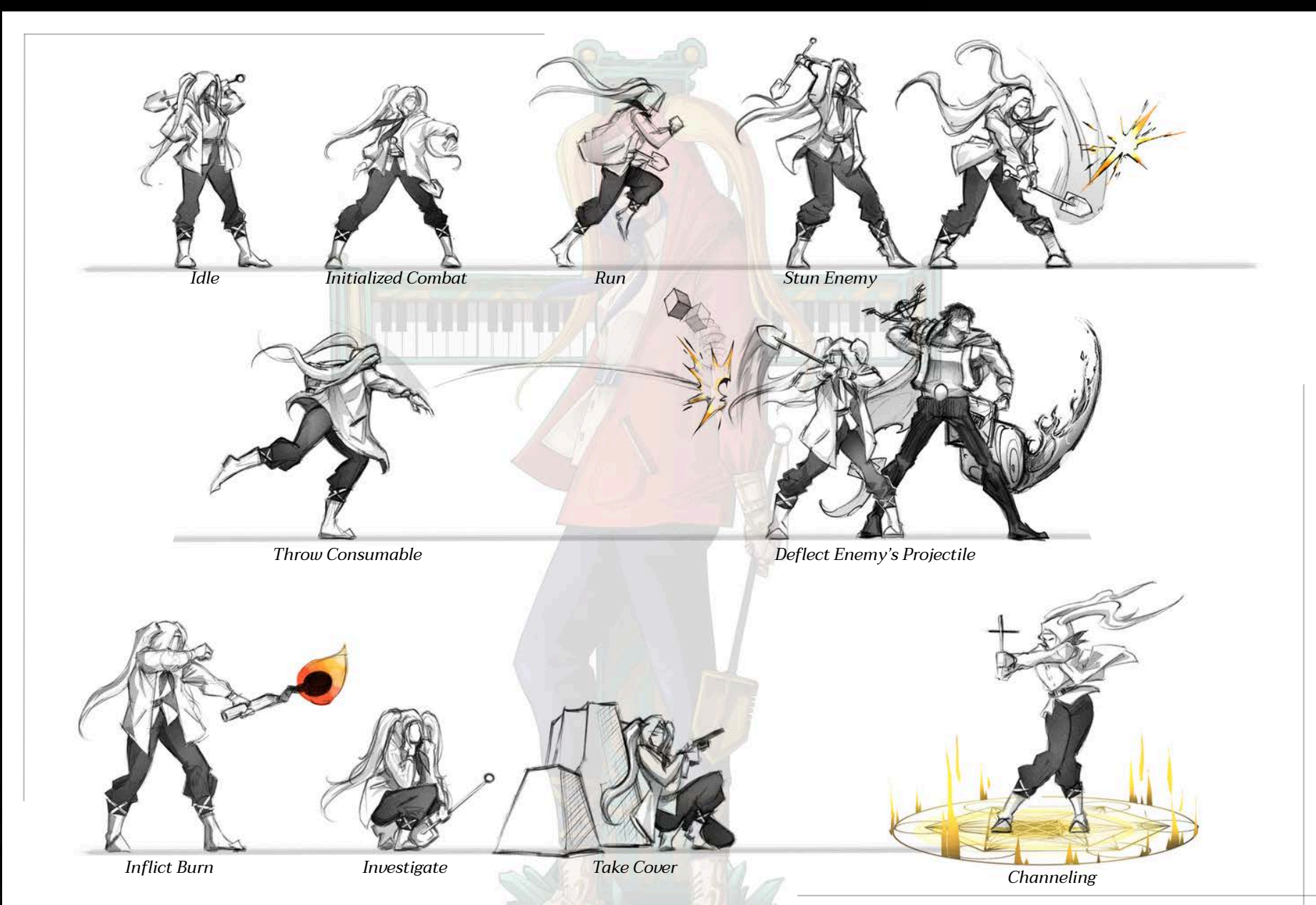
Exploration Assistance System

- Points out interactable objects or secrets
- Assists in environmental traversal (Help open shortcut, boost to reach high floor)
- Give some of drops form combat that player missed

Companion animation also sync to the rhythm of the current action background music and adapted to gameplay difficulty automatically to give player a smooth and fun experience and not being a burden or require a micro management.



Companion's first draft



ALICIA's Abilities



ENEMY ARCHETYPES

DEFINITION

The following behaviors and actions form the core foundation of how they attack.

Asclepius will face many enemies in each encounter. All enemies required to be fine-tuning and balancing in potential development. Like; standard movement, evasion, state, taunt, defensive and idle are required with their own units where applicable.

DIFFICULTY

Seperate into 6 levels.

1. **World's resident** - A wild lifes, evironment ambient creature. Can be hunted for resources
2. **Fodder** - Weakling enemy
3. **Captain** - A strong enemy with a name on it
4. **Mini boss** - Has its own health bar
5. **Faction's boss** - Story and progression locked behind it.

All this difficulty levels is depend on combo of its archetype and their unique attack move or the beat of music.



MELEE

A hand to hand combat. Common attack types include weapons.



RANGED

Means enemies can attack Asclepius from a distance with ranged weaponry.



SWARM

They will alert other members of Swarm during combat and bring them to fight. A common trait in smaller, littler threats on their own but dangerous in packs.



WARDEN

A defensive type. Most likely in a defensive state. Common came with armor or shields that must open their defenses in order to damage them.



SUMMONER

Summoner is able to conjure lower-tiered enemies to assist and fight alongside them in battle.



PREDATOR

They are capable of camouflage. Ranged attacks will not harm them until they stay close enough or alerted.



TITAN

A large sized enemy that can endure many attacks.



SHATTERED

A very low health enemy that died in any damage taken.



TELL-TALED

They came to represent Faction's theme or supported environment. Also have a unique sound, pose or weapons.



FLYING

Highly evasive enemy can attack Asclepius from the sky.



MASTERMIND

A smart enemy that knows when to attack and when to evade or defend. Cannot get rid easily and can buy some time in order to rally more enemies or let other combat members do their mechanics.



HEALER

An enemy that is able to heal other combat members or itself.

GAMEPLAY WITH FREDDY

The fight with Freddy is not that critical battle, he will not to move and stand there to perform his concert with the instrument in his care; The Microphone.

Freddy attack with his song note, its fly around the battle chamber and richocet like a DVD logo on the screen. He also can call his subodinate to the battlefield as the battle go on, he still not to move or flinch any player attack while he sing. As the professional, the show must go on

He has his own Battle Music that synce to his move, when the hook punch in. He stop the attack and dance to open the oppotunity for attack.



SUMMONER



RANGED



TELL TALED



X

MAIN BOSS DESIGN

COLIN THE BIG BROTHEROINK - A RICH PIG

GAME PLAY WITH COLIN

COLIN is the billionaire, he can do many capable things with money. His instrument in care is "Stereo Speaker", His voice is louder as his money talk.

COLIN can transform in to Banknote titan and also hide in his pile of money. His attack can echo between the wall in his combat chamber.

To surpass him, ASCLEPIUS and ALICIA must conquer together and make him glimpse about his brother to make him wimps a sorrow and open opportunity for attack

His Battle Music came up with the lyrics that flex about how rich he is



TITAN



PREDATOR



MELEE



XI

MAIN BOSS DESIGN

MARY - QUEEN OF HEART THE THIRD

GAMEPLAY WITH MARY

Mary is the one of the hardest boss fight in the game. Player have to fight in her strategic chmbat chamber, the chess board. She can command any pawns or soldieron the board to attack player or even help her out of the hard situation.

Mary also has her Asclepius's instrument in her care; The Violin. The sound of violin allow her to control all unit under her subodinate like a conductor and performer at the same time, that such a talented.

Mary is also a Queen on the board, she can move almost freely like a queen unit in chess. attacking her cannot harm her but stagging, and show the location of her heart and open oppotunity to harm her. Since her heart is at the King pawn.



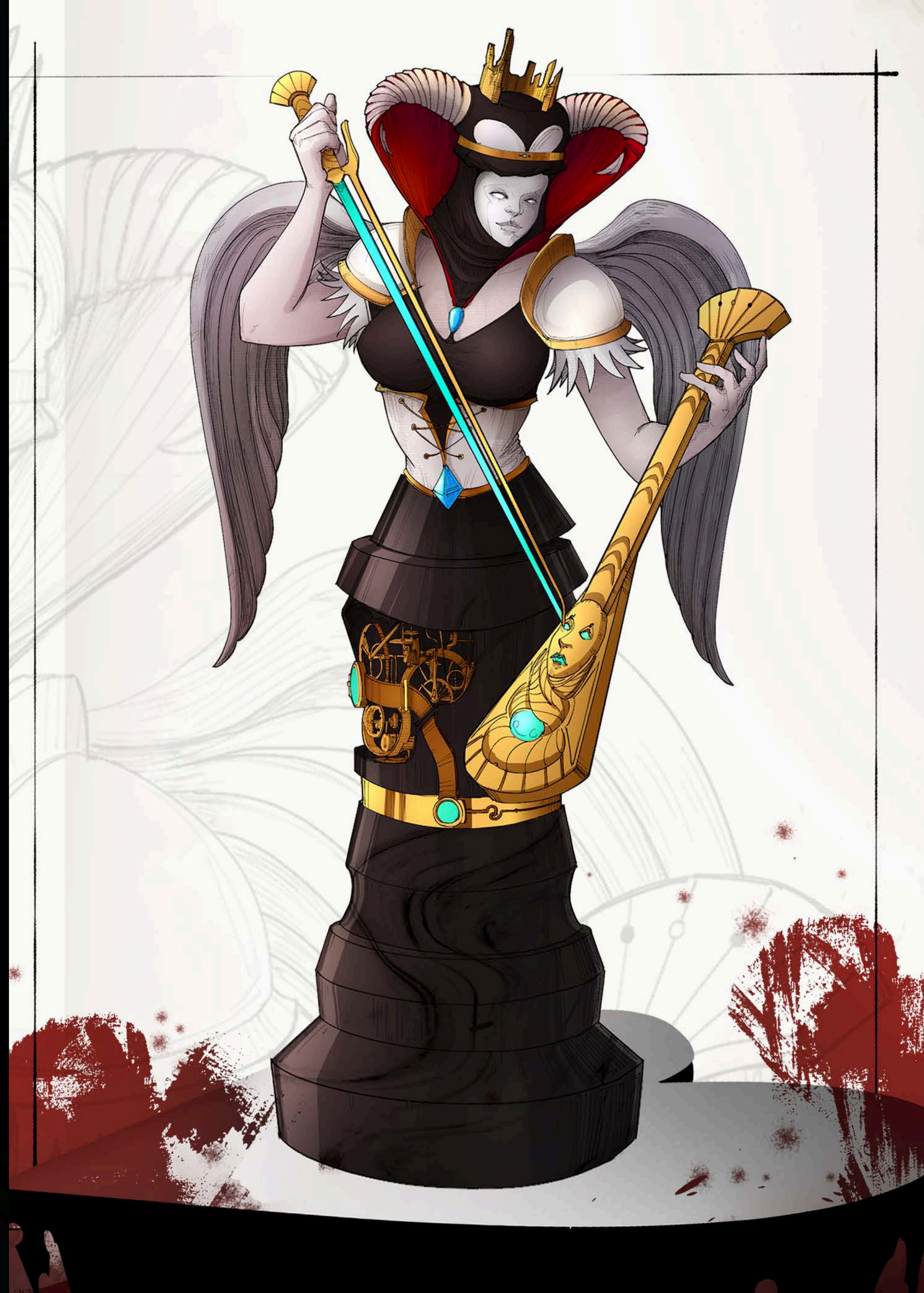
MASTERMIND



SUMMONER



TELL TALED



MAIN STORY

XII

The player takes the role of **Asclepius**, the God of Healing, Son of the radiant **Apollo**, the god of the sun, music, prophecy, and archery.

Though born with divine duty in his veins, Asclepius carried a different dream within his heart — a love for music, much like his father. He longed not to heal, but to create melodies that echoed noisy through the heavens. Yet Apollo, proud and unyielding, could not accept this.

One fateful day, in a moment of anger, Apollo gathered the instruments Asclepius cherished most. With a single, merciless motion, he shot them with his bow into a towering bookshelf. The impact tore reality itself, forming a black hole that consumed countless books, fusing many stories into one.

Enraged and heartbroken, Asclepius rose against his father. But he was no match for Apollo's divine power. Defeated, he fled — not from fear, but from despair — and leapt into the black hole.

Through its darkness, he was cast into a fractured world of fables — a land where stories had twisted into chaos. There, he met a girl named Alicia. Seeing her in the red riddle hood struggle among many wolves, Asclepius made a choice. He would help her... and she, in turn, would journey beside him.

From that moment on, he carried two burdens upon his path. To reclaim the instruments he had lost. And to heal the broken fable world before him.

For the first time, Asclepius saw the suffering his neglect had caused. As a god, he had turned away from his purpose — and in doing so, had allowed chaos to spread.

Now, in a world of shattered tales and fading hope, he must face the truth of who he is.

Not just a dreamer. But a God of Healing.

CHAPTERS

XIII

FACTIONS

The main story will be digested and devided through the gameplay and adventure of 2 protagonists travel around 4 factions

Faction in the developer's terms is a chapter. Each chapters is a corrupted fable that is affected by Asclepius's instrument and changes the appearance, twisted into the untold side of the fable.

This world setting divided into many factions

- Faction of the heretic runs by THE WOLVES
- Faction of the religious and communism run by THE NUN and ALICIA
- Faction of the capitalism run by COLIN THE BIG BROTHEROINK
- Faction of the monarchy run by MARY THE QUEEN OF HEART

Each faction got a problem of their own and many quests player can help them through story



TALES OF HARMONY's World Map

XIV FACTION OF THE COMMUNISM

THE RED RIDDLE HOOD FABLE

The instrument of Asclepius descended into the world of fable, its power corrupted the land of Red Riddle hood. igniting a brutal war of possession.

On one side stood the Church, led by the Grandmother; on the other, the Wolf, both vying to claim the divine instrument for themselves.

Grandmother forged church system as an orphanage, gather all children around the continent and trained as child soldier and give them the red uniform and weapons to fight the wolves and reclaim the land form corrupted. its one of the crazy cult if look form another point of view.



"As the story progress, the world start to corrupted, enemy will stronger each time the day process and player have to balance play time spend to progress story and cure the world"

FREDDY

"You.. You are the one to blame for this corruption YOU FALSE GOD. You dare destroy my new home."



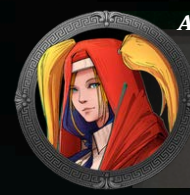
ASCLEPIUS

"Am I? Perhaps you too should take a closer look in the mirror. After all, not mine...alone."



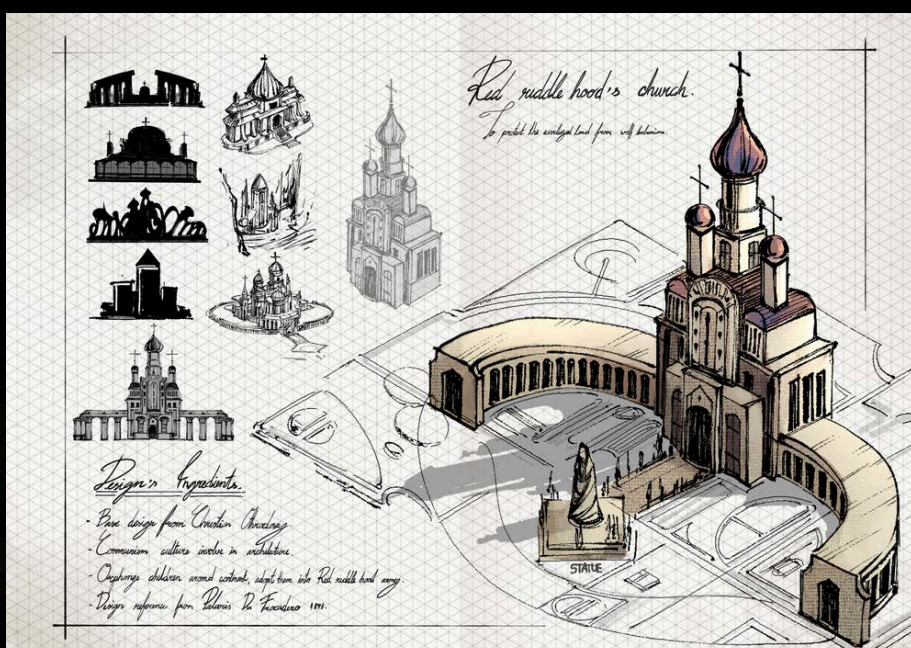
ALICIA

"This is nightmare. I can't let this happen to everyone home. but I must run, something always watching me..... or hunting me."



ASCLEPIUS

"I'll save your home Alicia. No matter what its take."



Church of The Red Riddle Cult Design



Corrupted Church Concept



FACTION OF THE HERECTIC

THE OTHER SIDE OF THE RED RIDDLE HOOD FABLE

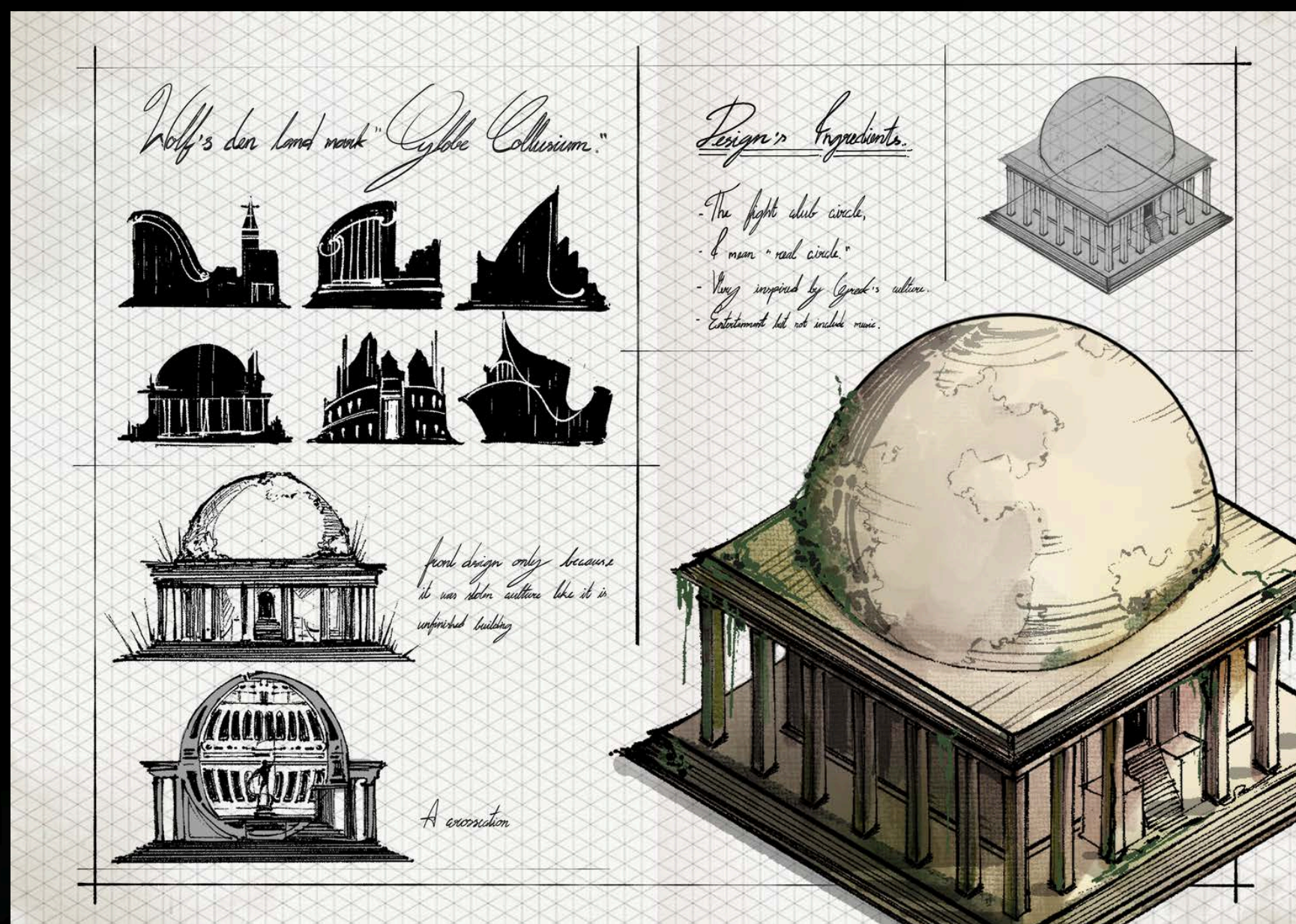
Faction form the red riddle hood fables. This is also the first chapter of the game. This factions represent war, Crusade between religious, conflict and chaos. Story of the wolf side that have to fight against **The Red Riddle Cult**.

Wolf faction stands for tutorials.

- They represent enemies tutorial most normal variation of enemies will me a melee enemy
- The beat of bg music will be stable, easy to learn and understand the game core mechanics
- Introduce companion system



Wolf's War Camp Concept Design



Globe Collusium Concept Design

Myyyy... kingdom

FREDDY



ASCLEPIUS

Indeed, feral. troublesome? certainly.



ASCLEPIUS

This place has no such a thing as civilize. There's only a man... wolves, So in love with greed.



Then, I shall take yours, you degenerated. To War!!!

FREDDY



GOAL OF FACTION

- Have a room of breath to let players explore the game's mechanics
- Carry casual player through the learning curve
- Hook, Punchline the story into the start
- Let player explore the environment and observe what protagonist's instrument does to this world (the war between wolf and red riddle hood)

XVI FACTION OF THE CAPITALISM

THREE LITTLE PIGS FABLE

The theme of faction is Inequality that happens everywhere in faction, not even between the relationship between brother or family. This faction tells us that we must conquer problems together with our companions like a Fable's quote .

GOAL OF FACTION

- Give more feature about companion system
- Introduce Instrument feature after gather form earlier faction's boss
- This chapter let player explore about what protagonist's instrument does to other people
- Focus on relationship between brothers of three little pigs
- The beat of bg music will be changed often depend on which pig's quest is going on
- This mean the same enemy can change their fighting style if encounter again another time story progress

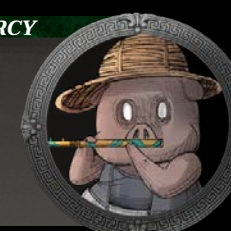
COLIN
Oink, oink oink>>?? OO II NN KK.



DIETER
Oink!



PERCY



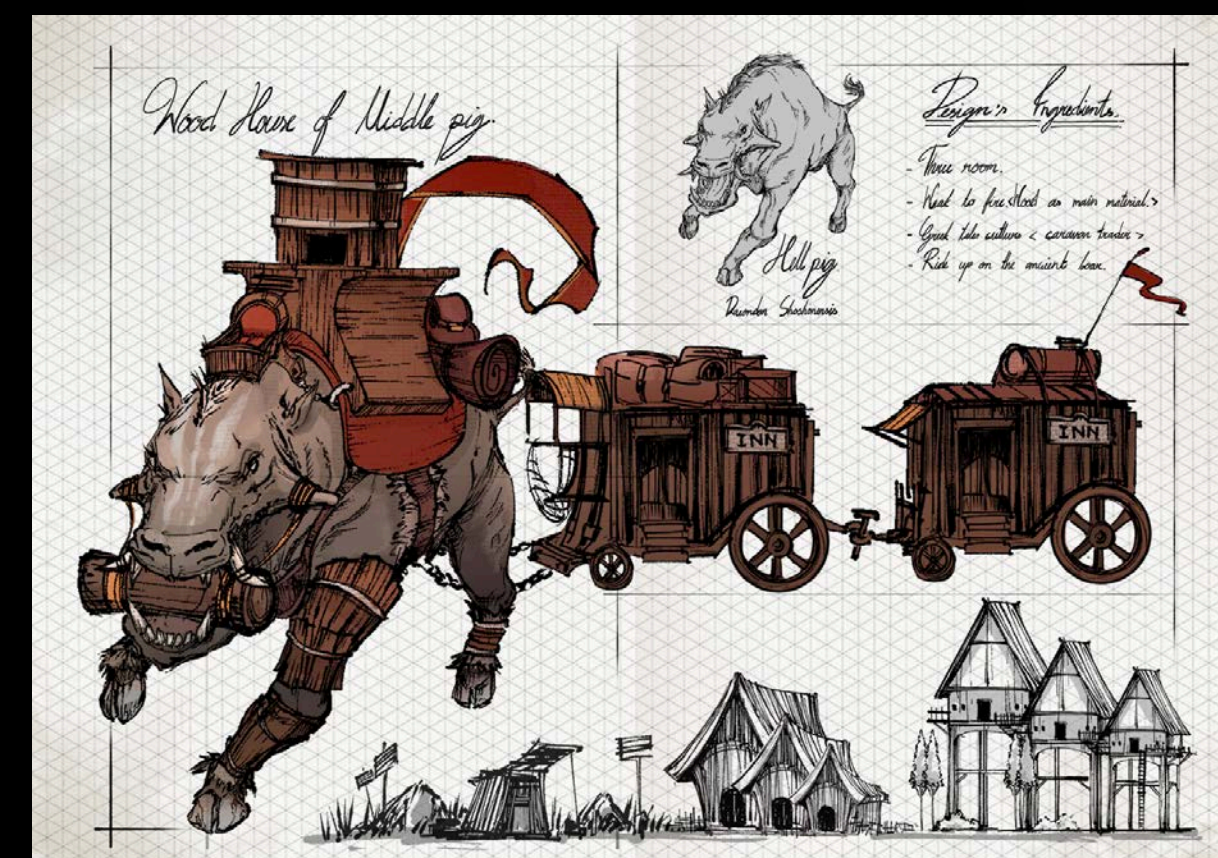
COLIN
Oink....



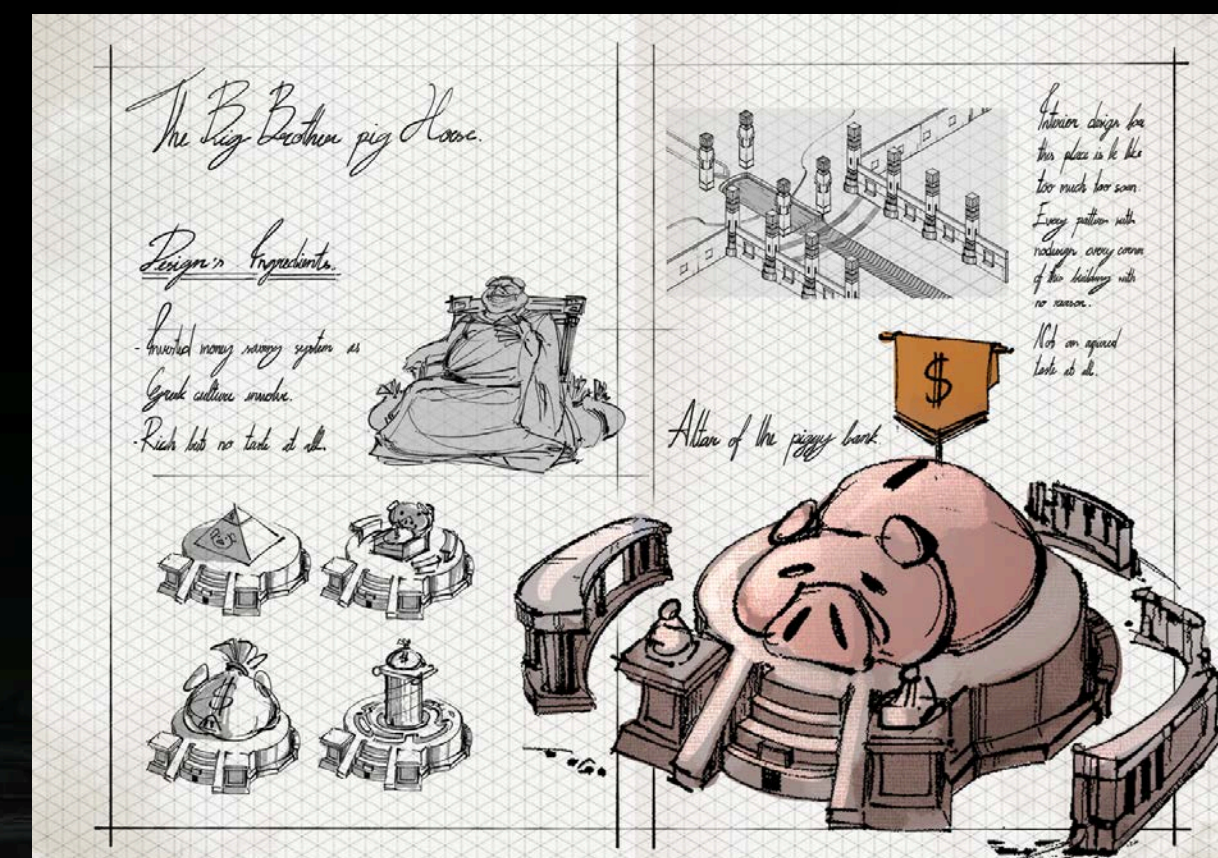
ASCLEPIUS
Seriously???



Percy's Hay House Design



Dieter's Wood House Design (On the other pig's back)

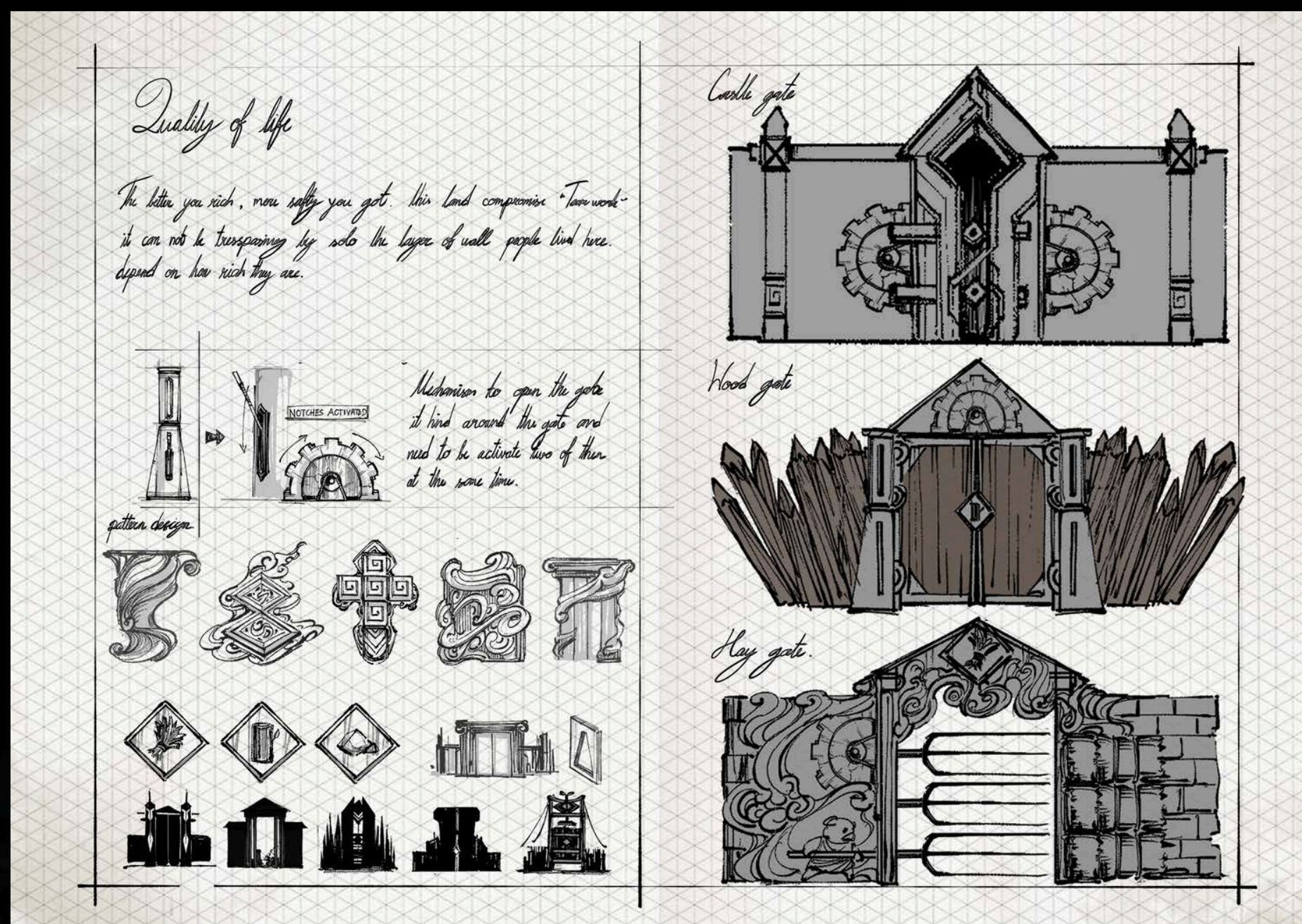


Colin's Brick Castle House Design)

"The first pig built its house with a straw, stick and hay with bare hand. He live with a three bed house, hopefully one day his brothers will come to visit

The second pig built his house with a wood, but on another pig back and bone. Born and understand how the Capitalism work become a grand merchant of the land.

The oldest pig is rich, thats it"
(He pay me good not to spoil)



Gate Keeper Show Difference Architecture Between Each Social Class

ALICE IN WONDERLAND FABLE

The faction of Monarchy this faction themed about love, rich and happiness but left the scar in the past to see clearly. The conflict of the world below is not affected here at all. The Monarchy just keeps their head above water. The player will explore inside the Corpse of the King of heart to conquer the queen.

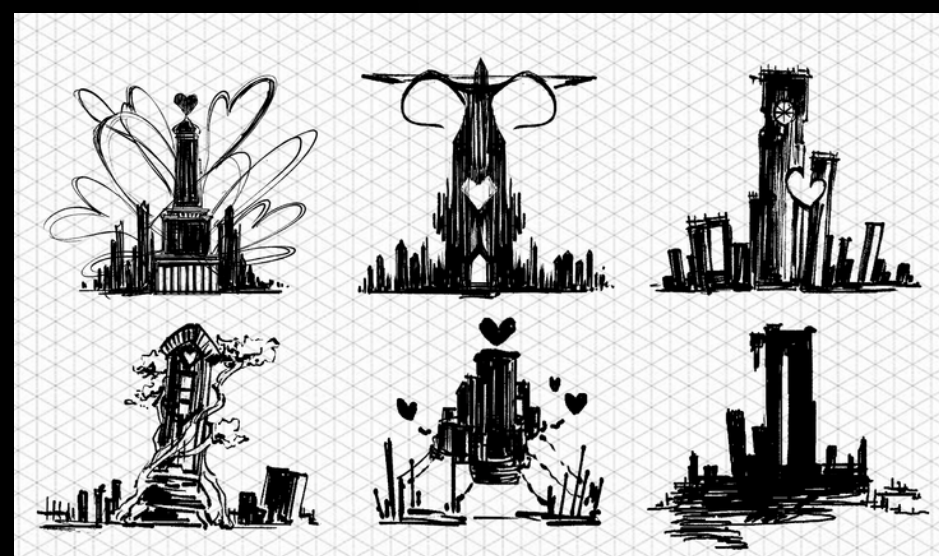
GOAL OF FACTION

- Present the Villain of this land
- Explore through her past, sadness and sorrow
- Focus on player's expression and mechanics
- Everything in this chapter always be a "game" like
 - Card solider
 - Chess map and puzzle
 - Flip map up side down
 - Contain sexual statue
- Music of this faction will be always fun, comedy and enjoy but the story will tell about sadness of the queen

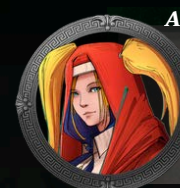
" This land... even the corrupt doesn't show on the land apperence. It's been corrupted long time ago.

The wolf built a house form a corpse of prey they hunted, the pig. Its in their genetic of corrupted people also the pig (Dieter) too.

The Queen built her castle and story on her grandma and her king's body that turn into the sorrow monument"



First Draft Of King And Queen's Castle



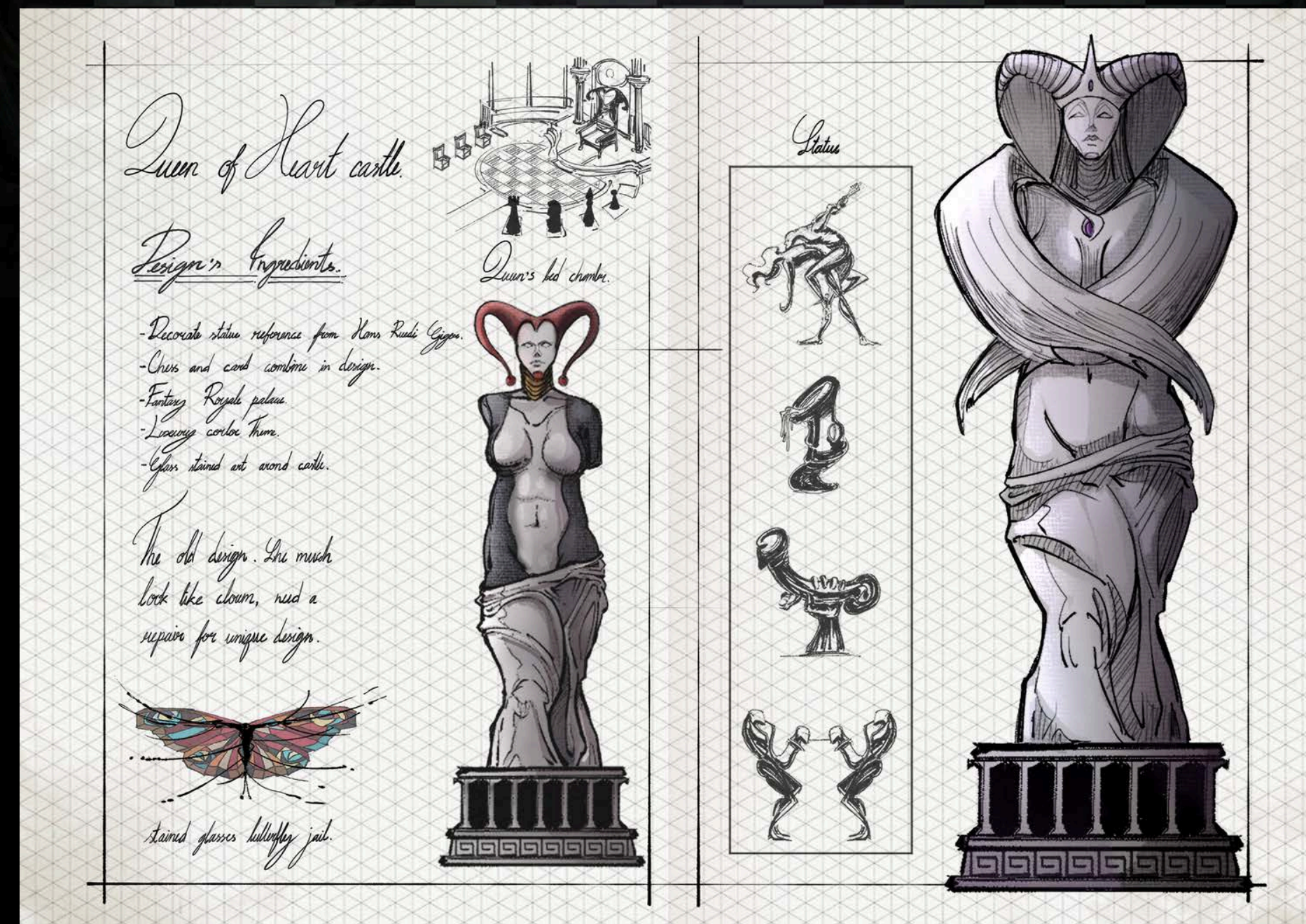
ALICIA

Salute to the deepest part of the heart, you majesty. I need your aids. This world is corrupted.

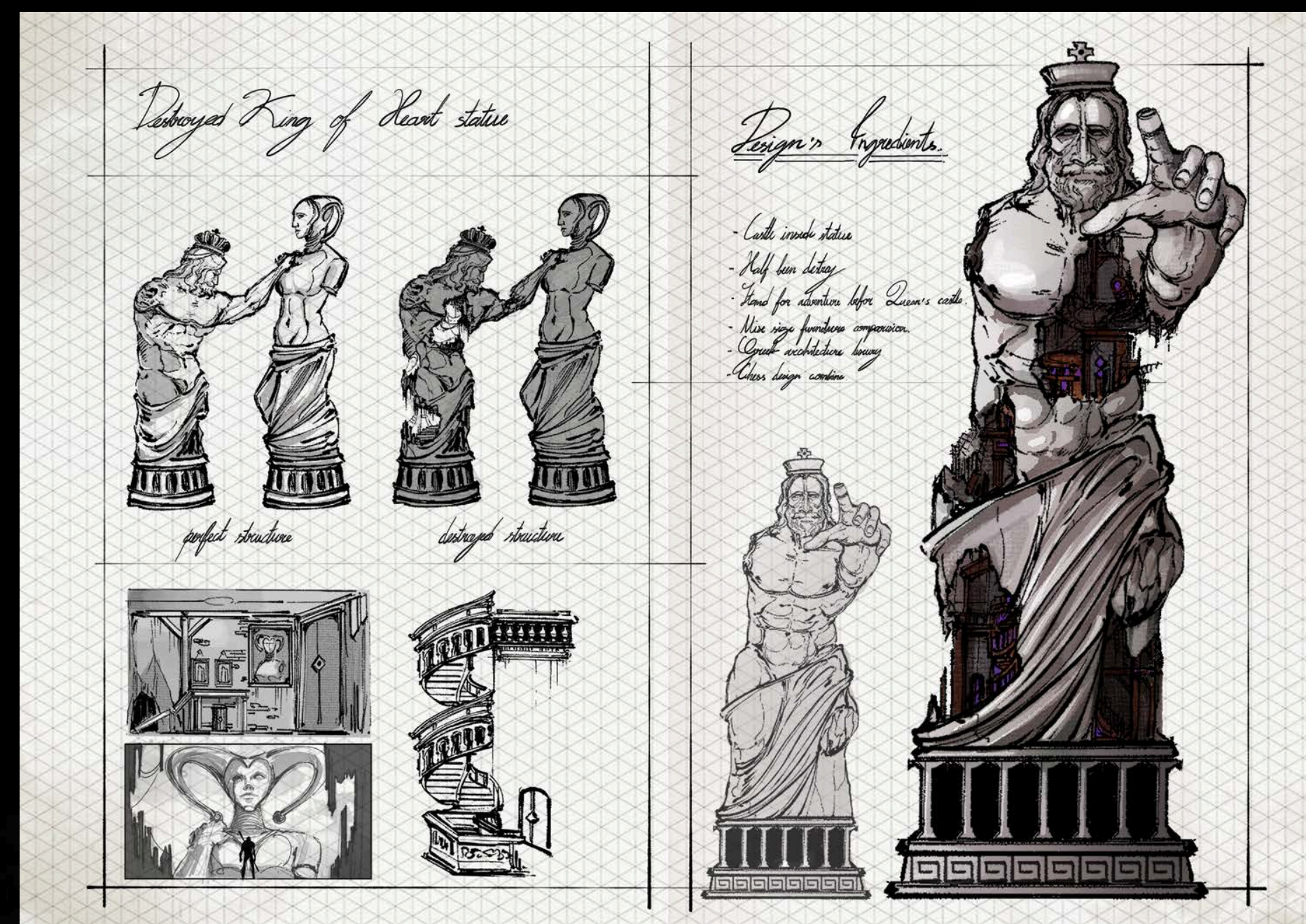
BOOOOOOOOWWW!! TO YOUR QUEEN, QUEEN OF EVERYTHING.



MARY



Queen Of Heart The Third Castle



King Of Heart Castle

ENEMY & COMBAT SYSTEM

XVIII

GENERAL ENEMIES

Each faction contain 3-5 enemies appearance separate into 2 Main type of the way they attack player

Melee enemy - Mainly attack with pattern moveset

Ranged enemy - Mainly attack with projectile

MELEE ATTACK

When attack, Character will play animation that spawn AttackWindow or Projectile that deals damage to opponent's HP

The **Attack Window System** defines the timing in which character attacks can successfully hit an opponent, be canceled, or leave the opponent vulnerable. Each attack animation contains 3 phases.

Anticipate; A moment before the attack becomes active, Do not deal damage also can be interrupted.

Contact(Attack Window); The moment hitboxes are active ,they can deal damage to the opponent. Matched to the landing hits animation.

Recovery Frames; A moment After the attack window finishes. Contain Input buffer and cannot act until reach Cancel Window

PROJECTILE / RANGED ATTACK

Projectile System defines all ranged attacks created by the player, enemies, and abilities. Each projectile that spawns and travels contains.

Damage – Base damage value

Direction – Projectile's destination

Speed – Travel velocity

Lifetime – Duration before disappearing

Range – Max travel distance

Hitbox Size – Collision area

Pierce Count – Number of enemies it can pass through

Element Type – (Status effect)

VFX and Sound

Subtype of projectile

Straight Projectile - Travels in a straight line

Arc Projectile - Travels in a curved trajectory or a gravity-based

XIX

DESIGN RULES, GOAL AND FUNZONE

Enemy and Threat in **Tales of Harmony** is varied, with each combat encounter designed to be a kinetic puzzle. However, Tales of Harmony is not intended to be hardcore genre and punishing combat experience but aimed to be a varied, creative and fun experience.

One that rewards curiosity, and allows each weapon choice of Asclepius adequate time to shine and to be experimented with.

The push and pull balancing the game is;
For the player to face combat encounter with a variety of choices and viable option to overcome encounter. To Successfully quickly adapt to rhythm-base and strategy against ever-changing circumstance on the run.

XX

ATTACK'S SUPPORT FEATURE

INPUT BUFFER

System that queue up player input.
Will do queued action immediately.

The Input Buffer memorized inputs that occur slightly before an action can be performed and automatically executed once the current state allows new actions

Purpose

- Improve input responsiveness and reliability
- Allow smoother chaining of actions
- Reduce player frustration

CANCEL WINDOW

Specific frames where actions can be chained. which the player is allowed to interrupt (cancel) the current action and transition into another valid action.

Purpose

- Enable fluid and responsive flow
- Support combo systems
- Add depth to timing-based gameplay

XXI

RHYTHM BEAT SYSTEM

Rhythm Beat System is a feature that synchronizes enemy actions with music that bound to that level

Enemy behaviors (movement, attacks, projectiles) are executed on beat timing, creating combat that feels like a musical performance.

The game Ai decides what to do on a beat standard Pattern (Beat Structure 4/4 Time) instead of the game's engine tick. Beat can be divided to 8 or 12 for harder levels or a boss fight.

Design Goals

- Ai moveset must be perfect sync on the beat
- Strong visual and feedback environment

XXIII

CORRUPTED SYSTEM

A corrupted enemy is a stronger variant of enemies and serves as a gate to the mini reward of that run for players to risk and take their chances.

They have high health and damage and use a variety of attack combos, some add more archetype into them. They also change the music to the corrupted beat when fighting to make all things go differently when encountered.

Player cannot escape the encounter after choosing to fight the corrupted. Each Factions have at least 1 corrupted enemy per run except the event

Corrupted Church

XXII

ENEMY'S COUNTERMEASURE SYSTEM

The Enemy Countermeasure System defines how enemies respond to player actions such as attacks, projectiles, and rhythm-based inputs.

Design Goals

- Prevent too stun lock
- Encourage timing and rhythm awareness
- Increase combat depth
- Make enemies feel intelligent and reactive

Counter / React Types

- Block
- Dodge
- Counter attack
 - Enemies endure the player's attack and attack back immediately

XXIV

NPC OVERVIEW

NPC FEATURE

All feature of NPC

- Talk to
- Harvest (Wild life)
- Buy item
- Quest
- Give Quest
 - Reward Quest
 - Give item

NPC LIST

NPC List

- The Nun - Guardian of AliciA (Quest NPC)
- Other Red riddle girl (Talk only)
- Percy - Little brotherOink (Quest NPC)
- Dieter - Middle brotherOink (Quest NPC)
- Mad hatter (Quest NPC)
- White rabbit (Buy Item)
- Dice master (Announcer of Faction of the monarchy)

Other NPC can be top up this list is a must